SIT's mandate—to catch the killer and not write a thesis on the LTTE in India.

A critical element established by the SIT was that Sivarasan was not only in India but had come very close to falling into the net of the SIT sleuths more than once. Anirudhya was writing a story on the acceleration of the manhunt for 'One-Eyed Jack'. He wrote:

> What enabled the sleuths to track his movements was the high-frequency communication device Sivarasan carried to keep in touch with Jaffna. The SIT managed to intercept coded communication between 'Jack' (his codename) and the LTTE in Jaffna.
>
> The investigators were expecting the information gathered on the LTTE'S contacts and activities abroad would be used to test the theory that a foreign hand might have been behind the plot to assassinate Rajiv Gandhi, with the LTTE as a willing tool. Though at that stage it was comparatively a long shot. Closing the case would have been impossible till Sivarasan was caught and questioned. Which is why the manhunt had assumed such overriding importance.[14]

After returning to Madras, Kaarthikeyan directed his people to take the initiative of collecting intelligence rather than just wait for various agencies such as the R&AW, IB and the JIC. It was better for the officers to check with the intelligence agencies on a regular basis to see what was available. Kaarthikeyan entrusted Sri Kumar with the responsibility.

A mole from within the LTTE informed Ragothaman that 'Jack' was armed with an ultra high frequency (UHF) transmitter. Sri Kumar immediately asked the Tamil Nadu Police that was keeping watch on the coasts along the state, the Indian Coast Guard and the Indian navy patrolling the waters between the north-eastern part of Sri Lanka and Tamil Nadu to be on the lookout for any high frequency communication. But nothing much came to the fore as the navy and the Coast Guard did not take